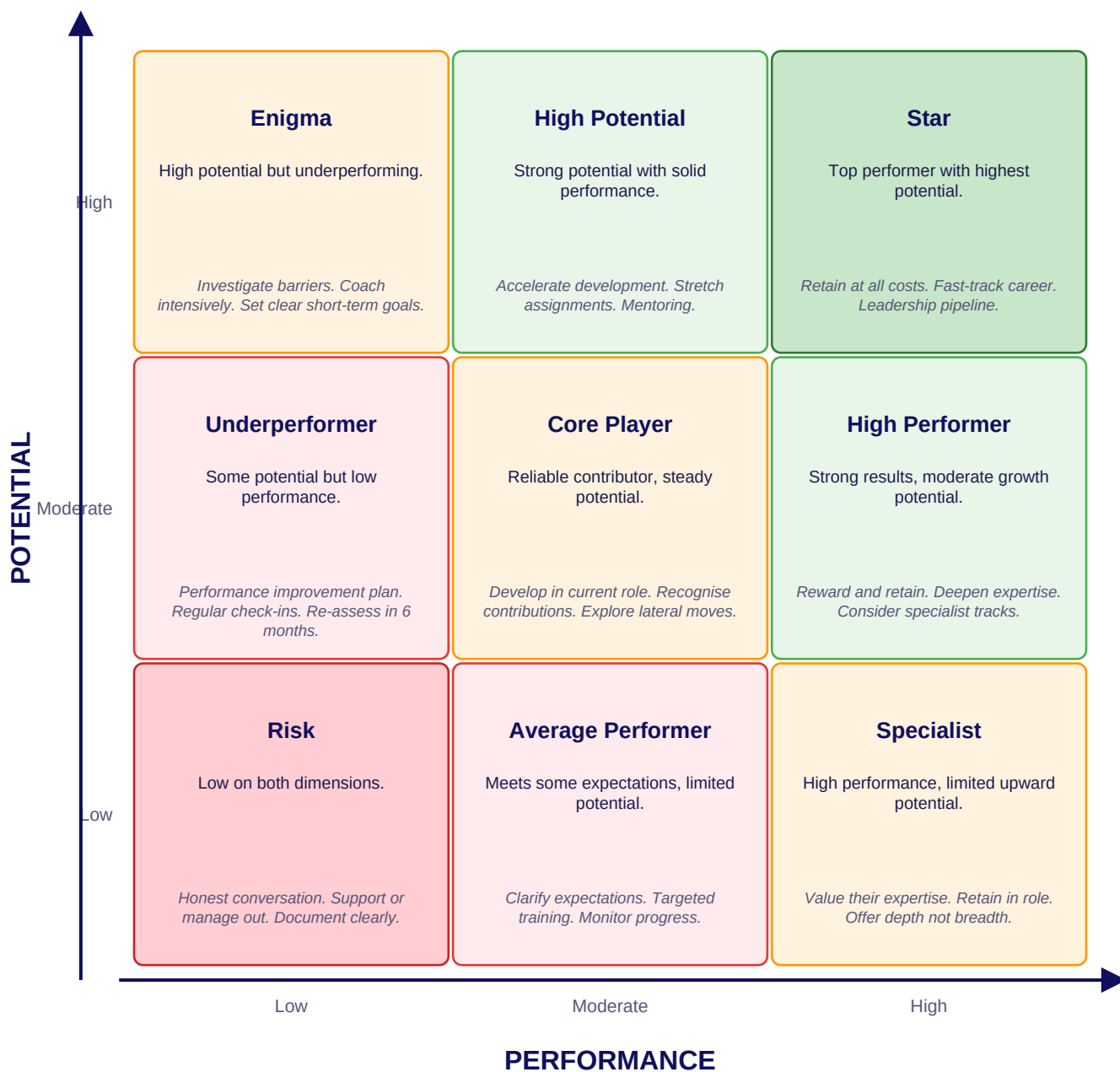


Nine Box Talent Grid

A framework for assessing talent based on Performance and Potential



How to Use the Nine Box Grid

Before the Assessment

- Gather data: use recent performance reviews, project outcomes, 360 feedback, and your own observations.
- Separate performance (what they deliver today) from potential (what they could do in the future).
- Avoid recency bias: consider the full review period, not just the last few weeks.

During Calibration

- Use the grid as a discussion tool, not a labelling exercise. Placement should be debated.
- Compare across the team to ensure consistency. If everyone is a Star, your bar may be off.
- Be honest about the Risk and Underperformer boxes. Avoiding them helps no one.
- Document the reasoning behind each placement for transparency.

After Placement

- Each box should trigger a specific action plan (see the actions in each cell).
- Stars: retention conversations, accelerated development, visible stretch projects.
- Core Players: don't neglect them. They are the backbone. Recognise and grow them.
- Risk / Underperformers: set clear timelines and expectations. Support, then decide.
- Review and update the grid quarterly, aligned with the Impact Scoring Cycle.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Don't confuse tenure with potential. Long service does not equal high potential.
- Don't use the grid to justify decisions already made. Use it to inform decisions.
- Don't share raw placements with individuals. Use the insights to guide coaching conversations.
- Remember: potential is about capability and aspiration, not just ambition.